

Niagara Recovery: Q2 2026 v2 Strategic Diagnosis

The engine dominates Niagara County core (100% LD cell coverage 0-15mi from pin) but bleeds 41% of branded demand to an old brand variant, and non-branded discovery collapsed 87% over the last year. Five pushes, not site-rebuild — brand canonical, GBP service-area swap, service-page consolidation, location-page break-out, content cleanup.

01 Executive Summary

The Newfane engine works. Across the 9 tracked Local Dominator keywords scanned 2026-02-22 → 2026-04-30 on a 13×13 grid at Newfane (158 cells, ~36mi × 36mi span covering Niagara County + the WNY metro fringe), Niagara Recovery sits in 100% of cells within 0-15mi of pin at avg rank #1-2 across alcohol-rehab, alcohol-detox-near-me, addiction-rehab, and addiction-treatment-center. The 4.3★/47-review GBP at 2600 William St is #1-2 in every neighborhood from Olcott through Lockport through Ransomville. **The dominance is structural and durable** — no defensive engineering required there.

Where the engine stalls. Three quantified drags. First, brand-conflict bleed: in the GBP's own 6-month search log (Dec 2025 – May 2026, 11,019 profile views), "recovery center of niagara" pulled **363 searches** against "niagara recovery" + variants at 528 — the old brand still draws **41% of branded demand** 6 months in, because the site uses two brand entities (homepage/footer = "Niagara Recovery"; about/admissions/contact/treatments/areas-served titles + LocalBusiness JSON-LD = "Recovery Center of Niagara"). Second, non-branded discovery collapse: GSC last-30d shows non-branded clicks at 47 against 3,967 over 365d — non-branded discovery has effectively halted (87% extrapolated decline) while the 670-post blog continues publishing (22 new posts shipped 2026-04-15 → 2026-05-18, plus 9 new suburb-doorway pages of the same template that v1 said to consolidate). Third, geographic break-out gap: the GBP service area is at the 20-entry cap, with **13 of 20 entries sitting on just 3 ZIPs** (7 on 14094 Lockport, 3 on 14008 Appleton, 3 on 14172 Wilson) — of which 11 are redundant micros that consolidate to 2 keeps — blocking entries for the 8 WNY anchor towns where Niagara already has 100% LD coverage and top-3 rank but no entity declaration.

Five pushes, M1-M3. Push 1 = brand canonical sitewide (one entity, one schema, one image, kill the [phone number] placeholder + Buffalo-14215 fabrication). Push 2 = GBP service-area swap (drop 11 redundant micros, claim Lockport + Cambria + Pendleton + Sanborn + Wheatfield + Lewiston + Youngstown + Clarence + N. Tonawanda) + photo blitz 6→25 + weekly Posts. Push 3 = service-page consolidation (10 URLs → 5 via 301 content-merge; MedicalBusiness schema floor; SP rewrites). Push 4 = location-page architecture (BUILD Tonawanda + N. Tonawanda where 404s exist; UPGRADE Williamsville + Cheektowaga + Lockport + NF + Amherst; REDIRECT ~60 best-/most-trusted-/dependable-/premium- doorways to anchor city pages). Push 5 = content cleanup (NOINDEX/410 ~300 off-vertical posts; refresh 5 high-CTR conversion blogs with intake CTAs; pause the suburb-doorway production firehose). Competitive landscape is winnable: Renaissance/BestSelf (2.7★/22), Beacon (3.6★/16), Casa Di Vita (5.0★/3 tiny base), Pathways CHS (3.3★/69) all beatable on ratings + topical density. The unlock is on-page + GBP, not budget — existing off-page rotation continues.

02 Health Snapshot

LD COVERAGE 0-15MI OF PIN

100%

158-cell grid 2026-04-30 — Niagara holds every cell in Niagara-County core at rank #1-2 across alcohol-rehab + detox + addiction-rehab kws. Structural dominance.

BRANDED SEARCH CTR 365D

17.1%

2,605 clicks / 15,237 imp on 20 branded queries. The brand pulls intent reliably — the engine is winning what brand-search delivers.

GBP SERVICE AREA

20 / 20

At Google's cap. 13 entries on 3 ZIPs (14094 ×7, 14008 ×3, 14172 ×3) — 11 redundant micros. Swap is the only path to claim Lockport / NF / Williamsville / Buffalo metro.

NON-BRANDED CLICKS 30D VS 365D/12

-87%

47 clicks last 30d vs 330/mo extrapolated from 3,967/365d. Non-branded discovery has collapsed even as 670-post blog continues publishing 22 new posts in 5 weeks.

BRAND DEMAND LEAKING TO OLD NAME

41%

"Recovery Center of Niagara" = 363 GBP searches over Dec-May vs "Niagara Recovery" variants at 528. Title + schema entity must consolidate to one brand.

PRODUCTION FIREHOSE CONTINUES

+31

22 PAA blogs + 9 suburb-doorway pages (Millville / Eagle Harbor / Abbott McKinley / Cowlesville / Marilla / Blossom / Attica / E. Oakville / E. Pembroke) shipped 2026-04-15 to 2026-05-18 — same doorway template v1 said to consolidate.

03 LD apples-to-apples 2026-02-22 → 2026-04-30 (158 cells visible both dates, addiction-clean intent only)

Of 9 keywords scanned at both dates, 6 are addiction-clean (per intent split: 1,500+ addiction-vertical listings per scan, <120 medical-rehab contamination). "niagara rehab" is the clearest intent collapse — owned by Niagara Rehabilitation-Nursing + Niagara Health & Rehab Centre (medical/elder facilities, not addiction); Google is correctly disambiguating. Recommend dropping it as a target. "rehab near me" is intent-ambiguous (50/50 medical vs addiction); deprioritize. **The strategic queries are alcohol-rehab + alcohol-detox-near-me + addiction-rehab(+ near me) + addiction-treatment-center + inpatient-rehab-near-me.**

Keyword	Coverage 2/22	Coverage 4/30	Top-3% 2/22	Top-3% 4/30	Movement
alcohol rehab	88.0%	87.3%	70.9%	70.3%	Flat dominant — defend
alcohol detox near me	95.6%	91.1%	72.8%	70.9%	Flat dominant — defend
addiction rehab	87.3%	85.4%	65.8%	60.8%	-5.0pt — Renaissance pressure
addiction rehab near me	89.9%	86.7%	65.8%	60.8%	-5.0pt — Renaissance + Casa Di Vita
addiction treatment center	84.8%	79.1%	62.7%	54.4%	-8.3pt — biggest regression
inpatient rehab near me	87.3%	83.5%	62.7%	61.4%	Flat — holding under medical-rehab contamination
inpatient rehab	79.7%	76.6%	51.3%	51.3%	Flat — heavy medical-rehab contamination
rehab near me	74.1%	69.0%	44.3%	41.1%	50/50 intent ambiguous — deprioritize
niagara rehab	17.1%	8.9%	17.1%	8.9%	Owned by medical-rehab — STOP CHASING

Chart-spec for AI rendering: 2-bar grouped horizontal chart per keyword, x = top-3% / 0-100 scale, two bars per keyword (2/22 light, 4/30 dark navy), color top-3% < 50 in red, 50-70 in amber, ≥70 in green. Sort: addiction-clean queries top, intent-ambiguous bottom, "niagara rehab" last with red bar.

04 GBP Service-Area Swap Proposal + Critical Issues (Push 1 + Push 2 anchors)

GBP service-area swap (current → proposed)	Decision	Critical issue (live-fetched 2026-05-19)	Sev
KEEP 9 entries: Newfane / Burt / Olcott / Appleton / Wilson / Barker / Hartland / Ransomville / Johnson Creek (unique ZIPs, 0-11mi)	KEEP x9	Sitewide brand fracture: 5/8 core pages use "Recovery Center of Niagara" in title; homepage uses "Niagara Recovery"; LocalBusiness JSON-LD ambiguous	P0
DROP 7 micros on ZIP 14094: Ridgewood / North Ridge / Highland Park / Cambria Center / Hickory Corners / Warrens Corners / Wrights Corners (all are Lockport neighborhoods)	DROP x7	"[phone number]" placeholder LIVE on /services/alcohol-detoxification-services + -in-newfane-ny dupe	P0
DROP 2 dupes on ZIP 14008: West Somerset / North Hartland (consolidated into Appleton)	DROP x2	Buffalo location page fabricates "our facility in Buffalo, NY 14215" — NAP-integrity risk for Maps	P0
DROP 2 dupes on ZIP 14172: South Wilson / Hopkins Beach (consolidated into Wilson)	DROP x2	LocalBusiness JSON-LD references niagararecovery.com/wp-content/* image (WP debris on Webflow build)	P1
ADD Lockport (14094): 13 cells in grid · 100% cov · avg rank 1.4 — single largest entity-claim win	ADD	10 /services/* URLs (5 base + 5 -in-newfane-ny dupes) for 3 clicks / 365d combined	P1
ADD Clarence (14031): 40 cells in grid · 100% cov · avg rank 3.4 — biggest break-out lever (eastern grid)	ADD	0 schema on 5 service pages + admissions + treatments + areas-served + 8/8 location pages	P1
ADD Cambria (14094) · Pendleton · Sanborn · Wheatfield · Youngstown · Lewiston — all 100% cov, rank 1-6, claimable today	ADD x6	/locations/tonawanda + /locations/north-tonawanda return 404 (gap matches Buffalo-metro Maps black hole)	P1
ADD N. Tonawanda (14120): 90% cov · rank 9.7 — Buffalo-metro entity claim	ADD	Lockport / NF / Amherst location pages = 276-278w thin doorways (vs Williamsville 986w / Cheektowaga 679w real content)	P1
Reserve 2 slots for Q3 (Niagara Falls / Amherst / Williamsville post-Push 4 location-page lift)	Q3	670-post blog + 22 new PAA blogs + 9 new doorway pages shipped in last 5 weeks (same template v1 said to consolidate)	P1
		All 21 pages sampled have null meta_description; Press Release stuck 7mo (Oct 2025)	P2 + Owner

05 WNY addiction-treatment competitor scoreboard — apples-to-apples cell delta (2/22 → 4/30)

Competitors AHEAD of Niagara across the 158-cell grid for 9 priority queries. Sorted: gainers (cells_present positive delta) above, Niagara mid-axis, losers below. Renaissance/BestSelf (BestSelf WNY 2.7★/22) is the most-frequent ahead-of-Niagara competitor for "addiction rehab" and "addiction treatment center" in southern grid cells — beatable on ratings and topical density. Casa Di Vita (Cazenovia Recovery, 5.0★/3) outranks in 78 cells but the tiny review base is the weakness. Buffalo Rehab Group and Niagara Rehabilitation-Nursing are out-of-vertical (physical therapy / elder rehab) — disambiguate intent, do not engineer to compete with them.

Casa Di Vita (Caz Recovery, 5.0★/3)		+78 cells (addition)
Pathways (CHS Buffalo, 3.3★/69)		+77 cells (addition)
Renaissance/BestSelf (2.7★/22)		+76 cells (addition)
Amity Club (4.4★/61)		+75 cells (addition)
Beacon Center (3.6★/16)		+75 cells (addition)
Cazenovia Manor / Caz Recovery		+65 cells (addition)
Horizon Village Terrace House		+55 cells (addition)
Niagara Recovery (us)		121-151 cells/kw · r1-5
Niagara Rehabilitation-Nursing		+314 ▲ medical (intent)
Buffalo Rehab Group (4.9★/114)		+306 ▲ PT (intent)
Niagara Health & Rehab (4.9★/1053)		+275 ▲ medical (intent)

Three of the five "losing" rows in red are intent-mismatched (medical/elder rehab competing on the "rehab" keyword family) — they're not actually losing to Niagara, Niagara just shouldn't engineer to beat them. The genuine addiction-vertical competitors are all winnable on rating + review-content + topical density: Renaissance (2.7), Beacon (3.6), Pathways (3.3), Casa Di Vita (review count 3). Push 2 photo blitz + Posts cadence + Push 5 topical-density cleanup translate directly to cell wins against this stack.

06 Root Cause, Ranked

PRIMARY · P0	Sitewide brand fracture is bleeding 41% of branded demand and starving the entity authority signal. Title + footer say "Niagara Recovery"; about/admissions/contact/treatments/areas-served titles say "Recovery Center of Niagara"; LocalBusiness JSON-LD ambiguous + references niagararecovery.com/wp-content/* image (WP debris on Webflow). Searchers respond: "recovery center of niagara" = 363 GBP searches Dec-May vs new-brand variants at 528. Entity-consolidation touches branded CTR, non-branded authority, and Maps disambiguation in one move.
PRIMARY	Non-branded discovery has collapsed 87% YoY while the production firehose keeps shipping the same template. GSC last-30d: 47 non-branded clicks vs extrapolated 330/mo from 3,967/365d historical — CTR 0.18% effectively flat. Yet 22 new PAA blogs + 9 new doorway pages shipped 2026-04-15 → 2026-05-18 (same template v1 said to consolidate). Blog has 670 posts at 96% of impressions, diluting toward off-vertical (porn-addiction 350K imp / vape-by-country / social-media addiction) + Newfane-only modifiers, not WNY break-out terrain. Push 5 = NOINDEX/410 the ~300 off-vertical posts, bolt intake CTAs onto 5 already-converting assets (~2,400 clicks/365d combined), pause the suburb-doorway pipeline.
SECONDARY	Location-page architecture is mis-allocated: Williamsville + Cheektowaga have real content but no schema or ranking lift; Tonawanda + N. Tonawanda are 404; Lockport / Niagara Falls / Amherst are thin doorways. Williamsville (986w) + Cheektowaga (679w) have substantive content but zero schema, no ratings module, no NAP markers — failing to rank (Williamsville 60-80% LD cov rank 5-6; Cheektowaga 37-50% rank 8-10). Tonawanda + N. Tonawanda = 404 (gap matches Buffalo-metro 0/7 cell black hole). Lockport/NF/Amherst pages = 276-278w thin doorways. Push 4: UPGRADE Williamsville + Cheektowaga (schema + ratings + NAP + service links + FAQ); BUILD Tonawanda + N. Tonawanda + Lewiston + Youngstown; UPGRADE Lockport + NF + Amherst; REDIRECT ~60 best-/most-trusted-/dependable-/premium- doorways to anchor city pages (small-level 301s per fill-not-kill).
OPPORTUNITY	11 of 20 GBP service-area slots are duplicate micros on 3 ZIPs — block 8 winnable WNY-anchor entries the team can claim today. 7 entries on ZIP 14094 (Lockport neighborhoods: Ridgewood / N. Ridge / Highland Park / Cambria Center / Hickory Corners / Warrens Corners / Wrights Corners); 3 on 14008 (Appleton area); 3 on 14172 (Wilson area). Consolidating frees 11 slots. Push 2 fills 8: Lockport (13c/100%/r1.4), Cambria (4c/100%/r1.2), Pendleton (6c/100%/r2.1), Sanborn (2c/r3.5), Wheatfield (3c/r6.0), Youngstown (2c/r1.3), Lewiston (2c/r4.2), Clarence (40c/100%/r3.4 — largest break-out lever). N. Tonawanda (90%/r9.7) mid-tier; NF/Amherst/Williamsville (rank 10+) deferred to Q3.

POSITIVE Newfane core dominance is structural — 100% LD cell coverage at #1-2 rank 0-15mi from pin. No defensive work required there; all engineering capacity routes to break-out.

Across alcohol-rehab + alcohol-detox-near-me + addiction-rehab + addiction-rehab-near-me + addiction-treatment-center + inpatient-rehab-near-me, Niagara holds 100% cell coverage 0-15mi at avg rank 1.0-1.7. Olcott / Burt / Wilson / Barker / Hartland / Ransomville / Lockport / Cambria / Pendleton / Sanborn / Youngstown — every anchor at 100% / rank 1-3. The 4.3★/47-review GBP is the entity authority for this zone; needs only maintenance (Posts + photo blitz + the brand-canonical fix that lifts the whole site).

07 Strategic Priorities — Q2 2026 v2 (5 pushes · 7 lever rows · 32 task rows · each → specific sheet)

#	Lever and action	Owner	Sheet	Impact
P1	Brand canonical sitewide. One entity (Niagara Recovery), one schema (MedicalBusiness floor sitewide, LocalBusiness on contact only), one image (live Webflow asset, kill wp-content debris). Title rewrites on about / admissions / contact / treatments / areas-served. Kill "[phone number]" placeholder. Fix Buffalo-NY-14215 fabrication.	On-Page (Aleksa)	Pages_Action_List · Schema_Plan	P0
P2	GBP service-area swap + photo blitz + Posts. Drop 11 redundant micros (7×14094, 2×14008, 2×14172). Add 9 anchor towns (Lockport, Cambria, Pendleton, Sanborn, Wheatfield, Youngstown, Lewiston, Clarence, N. Tonawanda). Photo 6→25 with category mix (treatment / facility / staff / outdoor / Newfane). Weekly Posts cadence keyed to addiction-clean kws + service-modality + payor.	Off-Page + AM (Julce + Miroslava)	GBP_Action_List · GBP_Service_Area_Swap	P0
P3	Service-page consolidation + schema floor. 301 the 5 -in-newfane-ny dupes to the 5 base /services URLs (content merge). Deploy MedicalBusiness+Service schema on all 5 base service pages. Rewrite SP-01 (alcohol detox, 790/mo Bing volume), SP-02 (drug detox, 6,600/mo), SP-03 (suboxone — top GBP-search demand). Add per-page meta_description.	On-Page (Aleksa)	Pages_Action_List · Service_Pages_Plan · Schema_Plan	High
P4	Location-page architecture: build / upgrade / redirect. BUILD Tonawanda + N. Tonawanda + Lewiston + Youngstown (4 new ~800-1000w pages with schema + NAP + ratings + service links). UPGRADE Williamsville + Cheektowaga + Lockport + Niagara Falls + Amherst from thin to substantive. REDIRECT ~60 best-/most-trusted-/dependable-/premium- doorway URLs to the relevant anchor city's location page (small-level 301s).	On-Page + Content (Aleksa + Marija)	Pages_Action_List · Cannibal_Cleanup_Plan · Internal_Linking_Map	High
P5	Content cleanup + cannibal consolidation. NOINDEX/410 the off-vertical high-imp posts (porn-addiction 350K imp; vape-by-country; social-media addiction; ~300 posts via decision-matrix scoring). Refresh 5 high-CTR conversion blog assets with intake CTAs. Pause the suburb-doorway production firehose (the Attica / E. Oakville / E. Pembroke / Renowned / Famous / Leading pipeline) — this is an owner/ops policy change.	Content (Marija) + Owner	Cannibal_Cleanup_Plan · Page_Refresh_Pages	High
P6	Off-page rotation + reporting (existing cadence continues). SEO Neo monthly · AI Articles (4/mo entity-anchored: Lockport / Williamsville / N. Tonawanda / Buffalo metro) · Driving Direction Pins monthly (Buffalo / N. Tonawanda / Williamsville / Amherst → Newfane) · GBP Posts weekly · Citations Tier 1/2/3 · GA4 now wired (192 conv / 794 pp / 365d) · LD recurring (6 coords × 8 kws weekly) · M3 close-out scorecard.	Off-Page + Reporting (Julce + Marija)	OffPage_Stack_Template · Reporting_Master_Template	Medium

08 Marginal-Value KPIs and Owner-Side Asks

- **M3 LD targets (apples-to-apples per-keyword top-3%):** alcohol rehab ≥75 · alcohol detox near me ≥75 · addiction rehab ≥65 · addiction rehab near me ≥65 · addiction treatment center ≥60 (recover the -8.3pt slip) · inpatient rehab near me ≥65 — anchored on Push 2 entity claims at Lockport / Clarence / Pendleton / Sanborn.
- **M3 GSC + non-branded recovery:** rebuild non-branded clicks 47/30d → 200/30d (4×) via Push 3 service-page schema + Push 4 location-page upgrade. Branded CTR hold ≥15%. Service-page combined clicks 3/365d → 50/M3 (5 base URLs after 301 consolidation).
- **M3 GBP scorecard:** Photos 6 → 25 (category-mixed). Posts 1 recent → 12 cumulative (weekly). Reviews 47 → 60 (+13 net via intake handoff). Service-area = 9 KEEPs + 9 ADDs + 2 buffer (per the swap proposal). M3 close-out maps to Asana Custom Strategy Tracking sheet.
- **Owner asks (one short call):** (1) Approve brand canonical = "Niagara Recovery" as the title-of-record everywhere; (2) Decide SAB vs storefront posture for GBP (recommend storefront — 24/7 inpatient supports it); (3) Confirm CARF / LegitScript / SAMHSA / OASAS listings for trust-page deployment; (4) **Approve pause on suburb-doorway production pipeline** (the Attica / E. Oakville / Renowned / Famous / Leading content stream); (5) Press Release task stuck since 2025-10-11 — approve or close.

Companion docs (Drive): Niagara_Recovery_Q2_2026_Strategy_Condensed · Niagara_Recovery_Q2_2026_Tasks · Niagara_Recovery_Pages_Action_List · Niagara_Recovery_Internal_Linking_Map · Niagara_Recovery_GBP_Action_List · Niagara_Recovery_GBP_Service_Area_Swap · Niagara_Recovery_Driving_Direction_Pins · Niagara_Recovery_OffPage_Stack_Template · Niagara_Recovery_Reporting_Master_Template · 5 Push briefs (P1-P5).